

Life without Facebook

Imagine the un-imaginable

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“I think the internet will help bring about world peace. If you have ten Facebook friends in a country, would you feel a bit different about bombing it? The line between “us” and “them” is getting blurry, and for many, it’s already disappeared.” These are the words of Dan O’Donnell, founder of positiveatmosphere.com, an “online and offline positive thinking/self-improvement” community.

If ever there had been truer words to give us an indication of how popular social networking has become, and how deeply it has been integrated in our lives. Not only have multiple social networking web sites successfully made the world a smaller place, but also enhanced the way information (sometimes not very useful!) is shared. However, like most things, social networking comes with its own share of advantages and disadvantages.

It Rocks: the good about social networking

- Superb platform to communicate with friends, meet new people and even rediscover the friends you had lost touch with over the years. From a simple “heya” to asking someone out on a date, social networking lets you communicate whatever you want. Depending on your message, you can communicate with one, or with all of your friends in one go. It doesn’t get more convenient than this!
- Sharing of ideas. Communities, groups and pages are set up to invite like-minded people to join in. Ideas and opinions are shared, with a global perspective, which otherwise would not have been possible.
- A great source of information. The likes of Facebook and Twitter are loaded with the lots of information. Links are shared, news spreads like wildfire and ideas are exchanged.

INTERVENTION!

- Turn off that PC and go watch a movie.
- Delete that FB profile and resist that urge to ‘recover’ it.
- Use suicidemachine.org to permanently disappear from some social networks.

Rumours can spread like wildfire too!

- It’s a memory bank, as far as photographs are concerned. Photos can be stored, shared and even commented upon.
- Instant access. Be it on the PC, or the smartphone, you are never away from putting up a new post, status or tweet.

Why Facebook became so big

You can run, but you cannot hide:

facebook.com, m.facebook.com, O.facebook.com, desktop applications, hundreds of apps for the smartphone, integration with countless web sites (the “share” button, remember?) and now email as